

from your computer sound control.

Step 2. Start the WXtoImg software and under main File menu, choose Record submenu. The recording dialogue box appears. This is where you need to start capturing the weather images from the satellite. Under this, click on Manual Test button as shown in Fig. 19.

Step 3. If the audio is not connected from the receiver to the

decoding software, you shall see a plain black picture window as shown in Fig. 20. This indicates that the audio is not connected to the decoder software, so you should re-check and configure the computer audio properly. Choose the File menu, then the Mixer Control submenu, and select proper settings for the audio connections and proceed to next step.

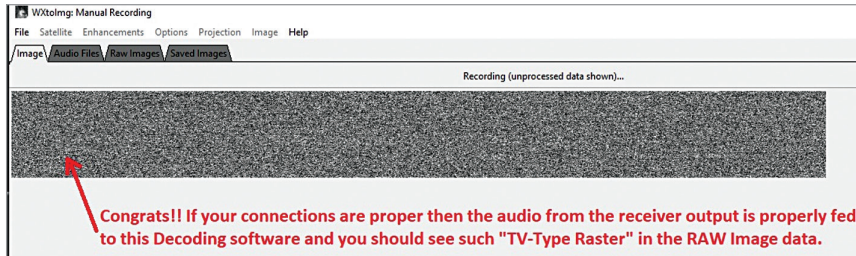


Fig. 21: A successful audio connections will lead to such Raster-Image in your decoding software

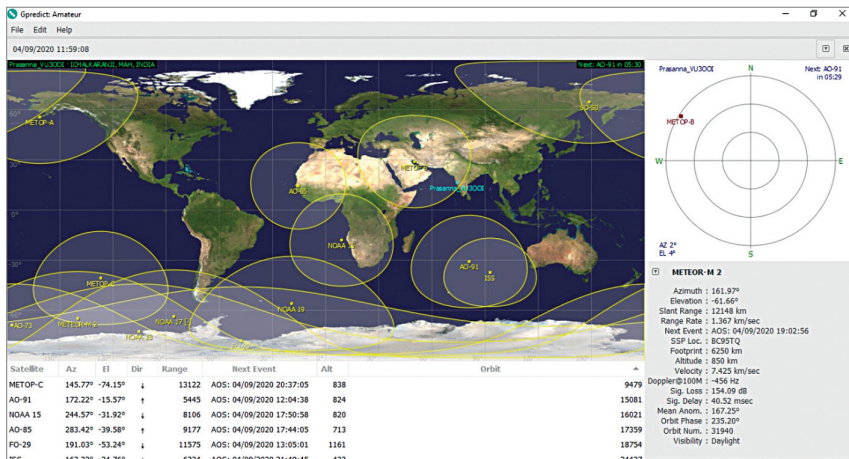


Fig. 22: The screenshot of GPredict as used by the author

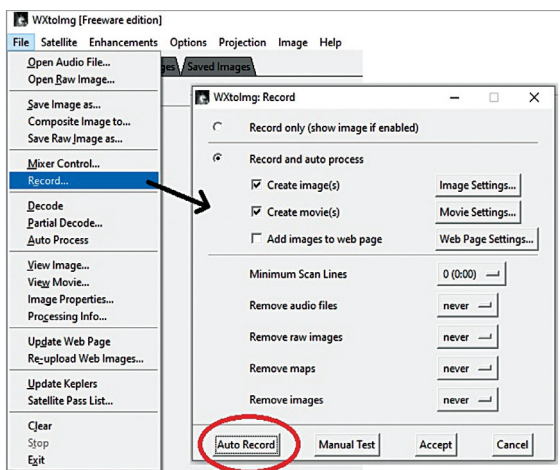


Fig. 23: Starting to record a satellite in transit

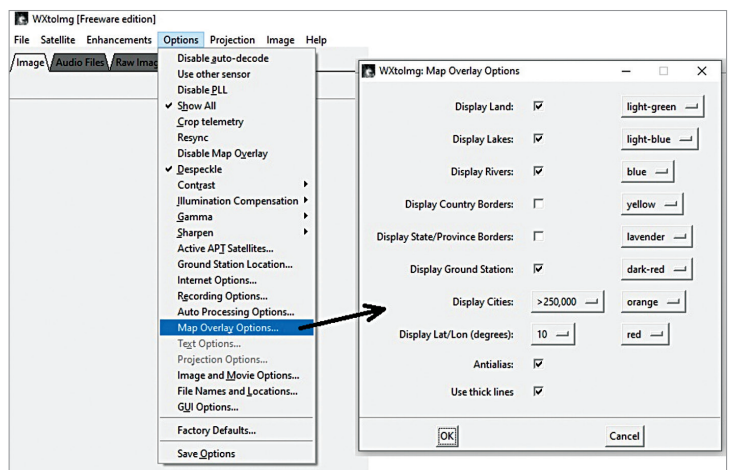


Fig. 24: Enabling various Map Overlay options while producing processed images

Step 4. When audio settings are proper, the WXtoImg software would start displaying RAW Image. If your audio is connected properly, you shall see a grey-scale image pattern as shown in Fig. 21. This indicates that your audio connections are alright. Otherwise, you need to go back to the audio settings once again.

Step 5. If step 4 is successful, go to the receiver software and tune to a dead spot on the FM band where no station is received. Then return to the WXtoImg decoder software window. You should see a TV-raster like image due to the hissing sound from the FM radio without any kind of audio (see Fig. 21).

If you are successful in steps 4 and 5, then all your software configurations are working fine and you can now receive the actual signal from a satellite.

Satellite prediction software.

Now that you are ready with the antenna installation, receiver, and the decoder software, it is time to find out when the satellite will come near your location. For this, you can either use an online tool to find the passing satellites, or you can download and install offline tools to predict the satellite trajectory. The author tried two options—Orbitron and GPREDICT. Both these are available as freeware and can be found at <http://www.stoff.pl/> or <http://gpredict.oz9aec.net/>,